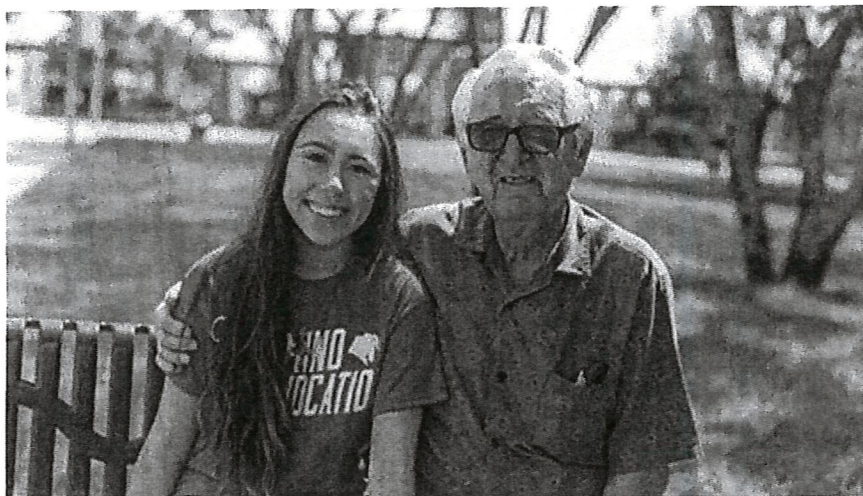


Answers

Listening: The Busy Life of a Retired Man



Look at the photo of Thomas and his granddaughter, Phillipa.

Who do you think is happier? Why?

Listen to them talking and find out.

Underline or circle the correct verb form

a. How long was he / has he been retired?

4 years

b. How long did he work / has he worked for Coulthard's?

over 40 years

c. What did he do / has he done with Rover?

walked with Rover. They were great friends

d. When did he go / has he gone to Wales?

last Easter

e. How long was he married / has he been married?

wife passed away.

35 years

f. How many holidays did he go / has he been on?

6 in the past year

g. Who did he meet / has he met on holiday in Australia?

American widow

Have you met = experience important.
who did = background important

Listen again and answer the questions.

Here are some words from the listening. Choose 3 by circling them.

Appreciate (v)

excuse (n)

senior citizens (n)

influence (n)

Companion (n)

widow (n)

cruise (n)

experience (n)

a friend / spend a lot of time with

older people

the effect/result

Listen again and listen specifically for the words that you have circled. Write the sentence in which you hear them. *Don't cheat!*

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Check if you have heard the sentences correctly in the script below

Finally, listen again and fill in the 11 missing words from the script.

P = Philippa, T = Thomas

P How long have you been retired now, Grandpa?

T Oh, let me see. Uh, it's four years. Yes, I've been retired nearly four years now. I suppose I'm used to it after all this time. But, you know, I worked for *Courtauld's* for over forty years. Can you believe that? Forty years.

P One job for forty years. Incredible I remember when you retired and they gave you that gold watch. Do you like being retired? I'd get bored, I'm sure I would. Don't you get bored?

T Well, I'm lucky. I've got my health so I can do a lot. I can get out a lot. I've just taken up golf, you know. It's a wonderful sport for an old man like me 'cos it's not really a sport at all, at least not the way your Grandpa plays it! It's just a good excuse for a walk, and I need an excuse since Rover died. I – I miss good old Rover; he and I were great friends ... but I don't think I want another dog at my age. I go to the golf club twice a week. I've made some

good friends there, you know. Have you met Ted and Marjorie? They're my age. They're a – oh, they're a lovely couple.

P Er, no ... I don't think I've met them, but didn't you go on holiday with them?

T Yes, that's right. We went to Wales together last Easter. Oh, and we had a lovely time, lovely time. I do appreciate company since your grandma died ... you know I really miss your grandma. 35 years we were married, 35 years and still as much in love as the day we met. She was a wonderful lady, your grandma.

P Oh, I know that, Grandpa. We all miss her so much. We all loved her so much.

T So I like to keep busy. I've been on all sorts of special holidays, y'know. Package holidays for senior citizens, and I've done a bit of ...

P Well, I know you went to visit Uncle Keith in Australia. And you've just come back from a cruise round the Caribbean. You're so brown.

T I know. My word, that was an experience. I loved every minute of it! When you're older I'll tell you about the American widow I met! ... Miriam, she was called. Oh, just a baby of fifty-five, but she seemed to like me.

P Grandpa!

T And yes, of course, Keith. I saw him two years ago. You've not met your Australian cousins yet, have you? Oh, you'd love the baby, Kylie, she's beautiful. Looks just like your grandma. But you know, I've also been to Spain, and Morocco, and Turkey. These package holidays are so good for people like me.

P Grandpa, next time, please think of me. Don't you want a companion? Can I come with you?

I'd love a suntan like yours! We never go anywhere interesting.

T Oh, Philippa, you know your mum and dad wouldn't let me. Not until you've finished your exams. Helen says I'm a bad influence on you.

P Well, I think *you* have more fun than *I* do! All I have to look forward to is exams and more exams, and then years and years of work!

T Oh Philippa. Don't wish your life away. Just enjoy it all. You only get one go at it!

Work in pairs. One student takes on the role of grandparent and the other takes on the role of grandchild.

Grandchildren: Come up with a list of questions to ask your grandparents about their lives in the past and now.

Grandparents: Come up with a list of questions to ask your grandchildren about their lives in the past and now.

For example: How long have you been married?

I have been married for fifty years.

Prizes for the most interesting interview!